

SOCIOLOGY AND OTHER SOCIAL SCIENCES

Relationship of sociology with other social sciences is given below.

1. Sociology and Economic

Economics is the social science that studies the production, distribution, and consumption of goods and services.

Economics is concerned with the social life of people in the special field of production, distribution, and consumption of wealth, goods and services. In these three processes, social life of men in various forms of goods and services is required. With the processes of social interaction, various functions are performed in which economic functions commonly operate. Without social contact, social groups cannot develop. Economic norms are evolved later from group contact. These norms include the rules of business, earning trade and banking. From economic contact, the social institution of economy is developed. It is concluded that the functions of the economic institutions are developed and governed by the norms of society. Study of society in respect of its norms, groups, and institutions is sociology. The functions, conditions and problems of other economic institutions are the developments of social life dealt by sociology.

When the laborers of a factory go on strike, the sociologist comes in and resolves the problem by arbitration. Here the study of economic problem falls in sociology. The study of poverty, unemployment, inflation is equally important in economics and

sociology Sociology of economies is an area of specialization in sociology.

Common points/ topics of attention are

Unemployment, inflation, human resource development, human resource management, labour welfare, human migration, brain drain, labour unions etc.

2. Sociology and Political Science

Political science deals with the social life of people in their attempt to govern themselves. The distribution of power and authority among individuals on the basis of social position in society and exercising social control are the major functions of political science.



Fig.: How the social sciences overlap

Sociology also deals with the structure and function of governing institutions and the agencies of social control. Moreover, status and role are determined and distributed according to the cultural values of that society. It is the norms of society which shape our values and institutions. The study of such things like values, norms and the institutions is included in the major fields of sociology. Without study of these concepts, the study of the institutions of politics is not possible.

Common Foci of Attention

Rise and fall of the government, election, propaganda, political change, and relationship between society and state are important in studying sociology and political science. There are some other common topics of interest for both sociologists and political scientists. Such topics as war, mass movements, revolutions, government control, public opinion, propaganda, leadership, elections, voting, political minorities, social legislations like civil code and the like may be cited here as examples. Sociology of political science is also an area of study in sociology.

3. Sociology and History

In history, the form of expression is often literary as well as scientific. It is based on written records of unique events like military conflicts. Political events, the activities

of rulers, the economic changes, and more recently the social changes. The historical record is a source of data for historical method, used in sociology. Past, present and future events are related to one another with one or more causal factors in a certain situation. This cause and effect relationship in the study of events is a logical method used in determining the cause of social problems in sociology. Historical method used in social research is itself an indication of relationship with sociology. Historical sociology is again, an area of study in sociology.

4. Sociology and Anthropology

Anthropology is 'the study of man'. In this subject, we study (i) Pre-history, (ii) linguistics, (iii) physical anthropology, (iv) archaeology, and (v) cultural anthropology. Main aim of these areas is to study the culture of primitive societies but the recent trend is to study the modern technological changes in various cultures. In sociology, the emphasis is laid upon the study of structure, function and problems of culture in society. Study of culture is a significant part of sociology whereas culture is the subject-matter of cultural anthropology.

Social and cultural anthropology is an independent branch of sociology and anthropology.

5. Sociology and Psychology

"Psychology is the field which deals with human nature or human activity in general". Mental temperament, personality traits and rising of the self are a few of the psychological areas of studying individual. Socialization process in sociology is one of the major aspects of studying human personality conforming or non-conforming to the norms of the culture. Several psychological theories like Dollard's— "Frustration leads to aggression"; and others are the important applications in studying deviant behavior in sociology. The common areas of study in which psychology and sociology interplay their parts is called social psychology.

Common Topics of Interest for Both the Sciences

Sociologists and social psychologists may have to study together certain common topics such as – individual disorganization, crime, juvenile delinquency, social disorganization, public opinion, propaganda, leadership, war conflicts, socialization, suggestion, imitation, fashion and so on.

6. Sociology and Statistics

According to Lundberg, all phenomena can be quantified. The importance of 'numbers' is evident from the verdict in social phenomena. Statistics provides the researcher with methods and techniques of measuring qualitative aspects of the events also. In sociological studies, we collect data, manipulate and interpret statistically. Hence statistics for social scientists is responsible for promoting the cause of scientific approach in the subject.

7. Sociology, Criminology and Education

Sociology covers the areas of criminology in which etiology (causes) of crime and methods of their removal are studied. With education, it has, again, a closer relationship in the sense that education is a rational method of making people useful members of society. In teaching norms of culture to individuals, education gains an important hand in the transmission of cultural values to the succeeding generation.